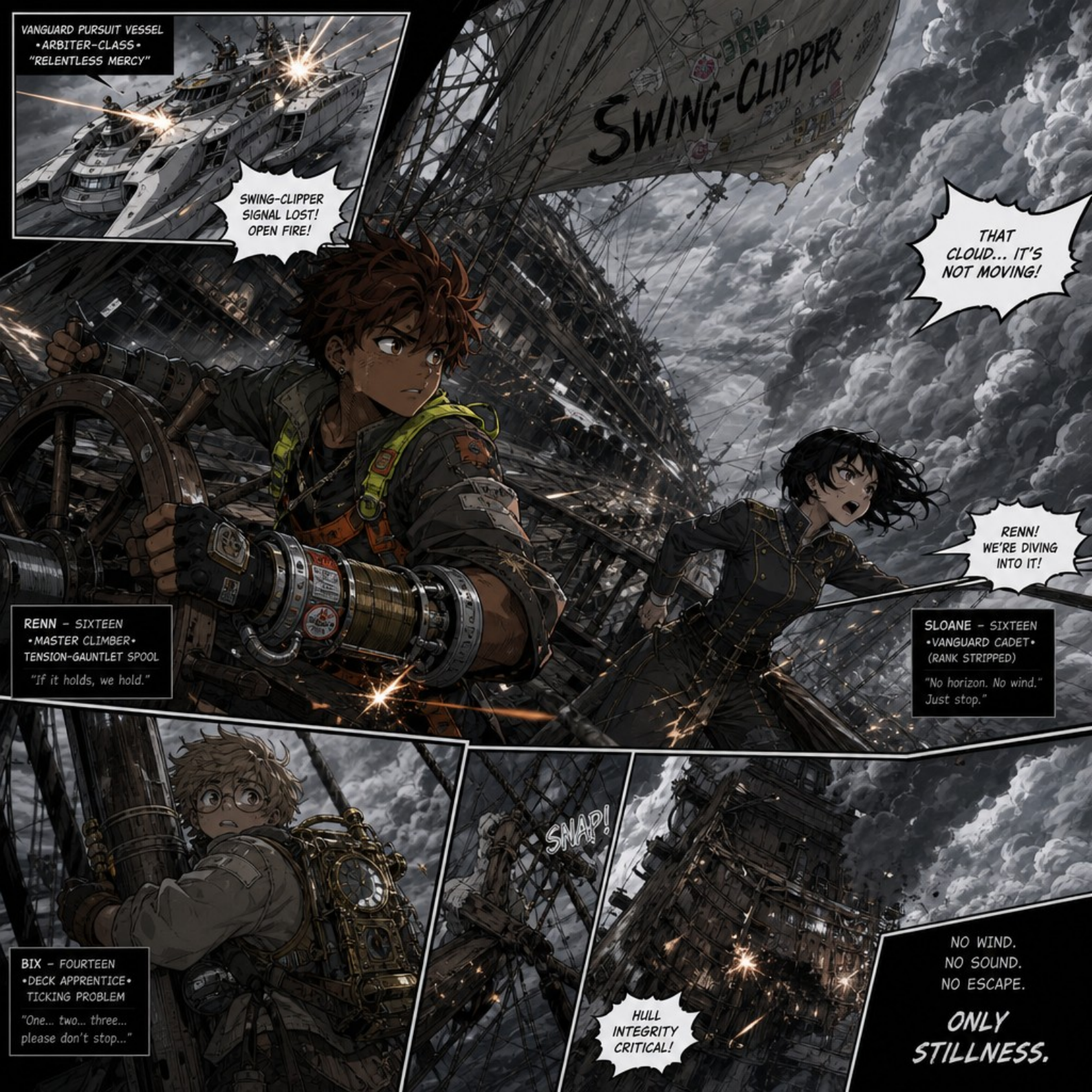




EPISODE 014:

WEFTSTORM

— THREADS REMEMBER. WE DO NOT. —



VANGUARD PURSUIT VESSEL
• ARBITER-CLASS •
"RELENTLESS MERCY"

SWING-CLIPPER
SIGNAL LOST!
OPEN FIRE!

THAT
CLOUD... IT'S
NOT MOVING!

RENN!
WE'RE DIVING
INTO IT!

RENN - SIXTEEN
• MASTER CLIMBER •
TENSION-GAUNTLET SPOOL
"If it holds, we hold."

SLOANE - SIXTEEN
• VANGUARD CADET •
(RANK STRIPPED)

"No horizon. No wind."
Just stop."

BIX - FOURTEEN
• DECK APPRENTICE •
TICKING PROBLEM

"One... two... three...
please don't stop..."

SNAP!

HULL
INTEGRITY
CRITICAL!

NO WIND.
NO SOUND.
NO ESCAPE.

ONLY
STILLNESS.

THREADS OF FATE

CHAPTER 14

THE DEAD ZONE

THE DEADZONE.

NO WEFT-LINES.
NO CURRENT.
NO SONG.

ONLY STILLNESS.
ONLY WEIGHT.
ONLY THE LONG FALL.

RENN.
SIXTEEN.
HE PUNCHES
THE SILENCE,
GRASPS
NOTHING.
AGAIN.

C'MON—
THERE'S
NOTHING
THERE!

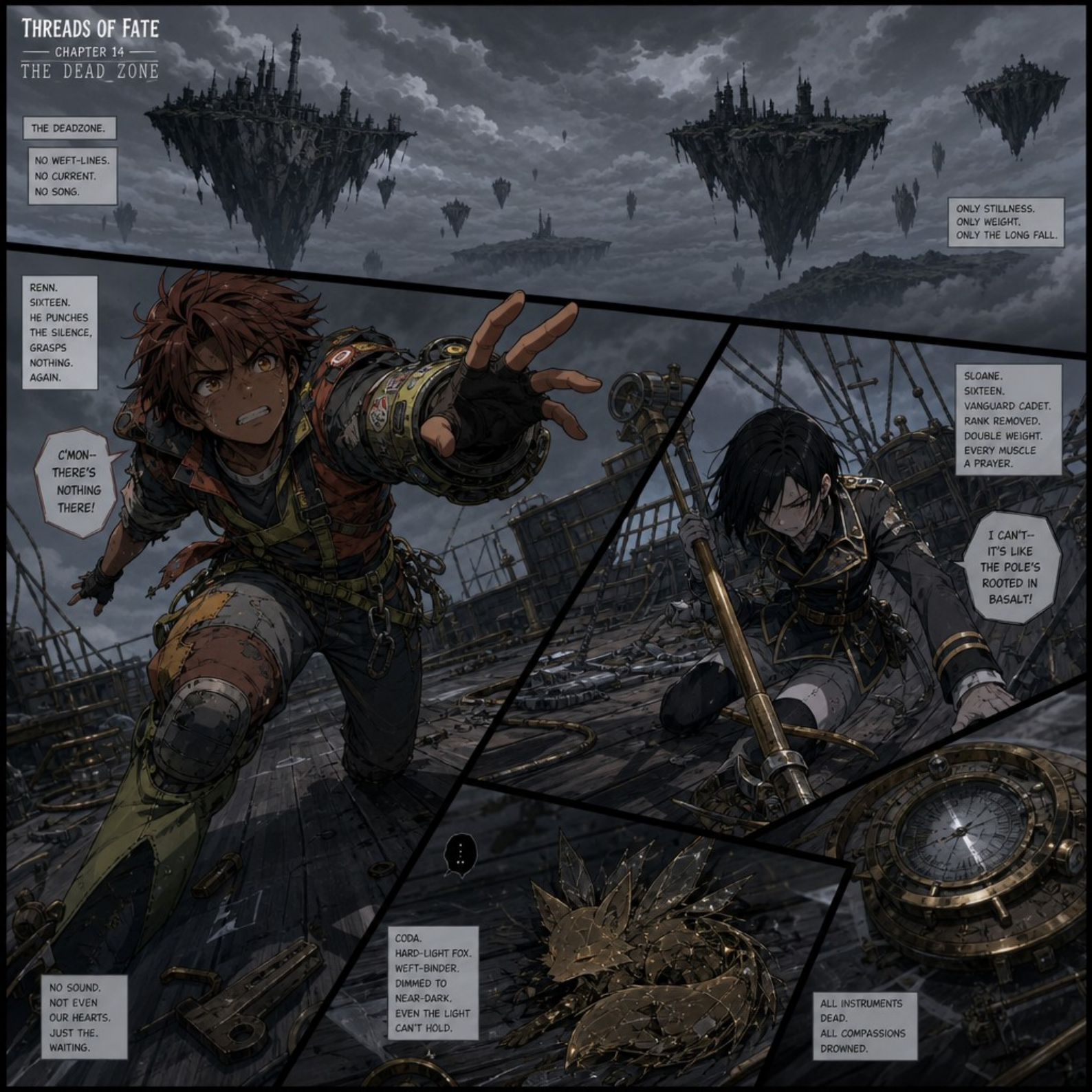
SLOANE.
SIXTEEN.
VANGUARD CADET.
RANK REMOVED.
DOUBLE WEIGHT.
EVERY MUSCLE
A PRAYER.

I CAN'T—
IT'S LIKE
THE POLE'S
ROOTED IN
BASALT!

CODA.
HARD-LIGHT FOX.
WEFT-BINDER.
DIMMED TO
NEAR-DARK,
EVEN THE LIGHT
CAN'T HOLD.

NO SOUND.
NOT EVEN
OUR HEARTS.
JUST THE.
WAITING.

ALL INSTRUMENTS
DEAD.
ALL COMPASSIONS
DROWNED.



THE SWING-CLIPPER
LISTS LIKE A WOUNDED
THING, SINKING DEEPER
INTO THE DEADZONE.

NO WIND.

NO SOUND.

ONLY THE PULL
BELOW.

BIT
MORE
LEFT!

BIX. FOURTEEN.
THE SIGNALS ARE HIS.
THE CONFIDENCE
IS NEW.

SLACK...

...TENSE...

...SNAP!

RENN. SIXTEEN.
THE TENSION-GAUNTLET
BITES AND GRINDS.
HE HAULS LIKE
HE WAS BORN
FOR THIS.

SLOANE. SIXTEEN.
VANGUARD CADET.
RANK STRIPPED.
PRIDE INTACT.

SHE ANCHORS.
SHE HOLDS.

SHE DOES
NOT YIELD.

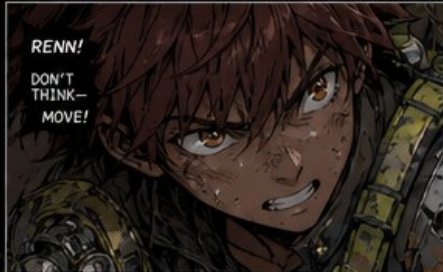
THE DECK
CRACKS.
THE BRASS
TREMBLES.
THE VOID
SWALLOWS.

KREENNK...

CLATTER...

HOLD
THAT
LINE!
NOW!

ANXIOUS EYES.
SUDDEN CLARITY.
A LEADER
IS BORN IN
THE FALL.



RENN!
DON'T
THINK—
MOVE!



CORALHOUND PACK.
MOEL: CR-HND06
STATUS: HUNGRY.



>HUFF<
>HUFF<
DOUBLE
GRAVITY.
EVERY
MOVE
COUNTS.



THE ISLAND'S SINKING.
THE MIST ISN'T
MOVING.
NOTHING HERE
IS.



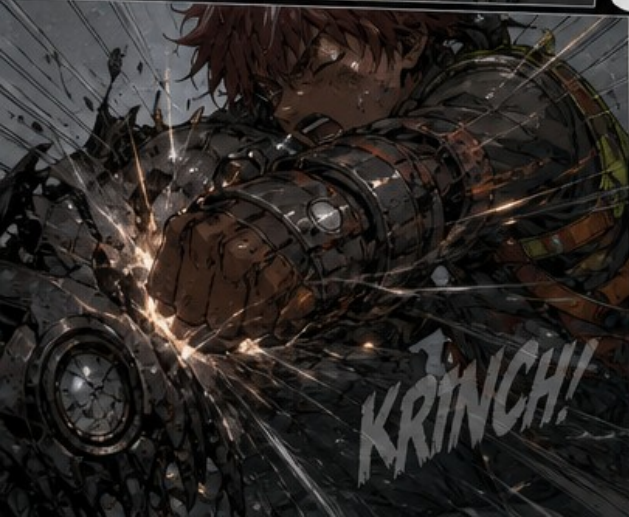
NNGH!



HEAVY...
SO
HEAVY...



WHUDD



KRINCH!



LENS
BREACHED.
TARGET
ENGAGED.

NO TETHERS.
NO DISTRACTIONS.
JUST BONE, METAL,
AND WILL.
SURVIVE THE SINKING.
THEN WORRY ABOUT
TOMORROW.

BELOWDECKS.
ENGINE ROOM. STARBOARD.
THE WINDHAWK.

PRESSURE'S
DROPPING FAST!

WE'VE
GOT MAYBE
THIRTY SECONDS
BEFORE--

CRACK!

STEAM VALVE
SEAL'S GONE!
CAN'T HOLD!

BIX.
AGE: 14

RENN.
AGE: 16

THEN
WE HOLD IT
TOGETHER!

YOU WIRE,
I BRACE!

COME ON, BIX--
FOCUS!

THEN
WE HOLD IT
TOGETHER!

I-I CAN
GET THE WIRING
TO HOLD, BUT THE
CONDUIT'S FRAYED--!

IT MIGHT
SHORT! THE
CURRENT--!

I-I...

THE COPPER'S
BARE IN THREE
PLACES!

NOT ON MY
WATCH!

RIVETS ARE
SHAKING LOOSE!

THE WHOLE
FRAME IS
SINGING!

KEEP IT
TOGETHER,
OLD GIRL...!

CHK-CHK-CHK-
CHK-CK-CHK-
CHK-CHK-CHK--

WHUMP! WHUMP!

PRESSURE
CRITICAL!
15 SECONDS!

WE DO
THIS NOW--
OR WE DON'T
DO ANYTHING!

LET'S
GO!

THE GREY WAS A LIE.

THE WEFT REMEMBERS.

WE'RE
THROUGH!

SHRAANK

HOLD
ON!

RENN.
SIXTEEN.

TENSION
GAUNTLET
ONLINE.

THREADS
REBOUNDING!

SLOANE.
SIXTEEN.

GRAVITY
NORMALIZING.
FINALLY.

CODA.

TRUEWEFT
STABILIZING!

PLAYTIME
RESUMED!

COLOR
RETURNS.

SO DOES
EVERYTHING
WE LOST.

WE DID IT.

NOT YET.

THE VANGUARD
WILL PURSUE.

THEN LET
THEM CATCH
SOMETHING
BEAUTIFUL.

FULL POWER
AHEAD!

THREADS SNAP.

COLOR FLOODS.

WE LIVE.

THAT IS ENOUGH.

SUNDOWN.

WE'RE ALIVE.
THAT'S... SOMETHING.

THE REST CAN
WAIT UNTIL
MORNING.

COUNT
THE DAMAGE.

PORT SIDE
TOOK THE WORST
OF IT.

THIS PLANK'S
NEAR TEN FEET
CRACKED.

RENN. 16

TENSION-GAUNTLET:
SPOOL CLASS.

BURNED
THROUGH.

RIGGING
SHEARED.

PULLEY
LOOSE.

MAIN MAST
RIGGING. THREE
LINES OUT.

FORE SAIL
PATCHED.
BARELY.

SLOANE. 16

VANGUARD CADET.
STRIPPED OF RANK.

TICK.

...TICK...

TICK.

BIX. 14

FIELD CHRONOMETER.
ANXIOUS. EXHAUSTED.

THE VAGRANT
Drift Class
Third Watch
Above the Shroud

WHUMP...
CRIK...

FOCUS.
THERE.

KLIK
TIK—
TIK—

B-BIX.
FOURTEEN.

I-I DON'T KNOW
IF THIS IS RIGHT—

TIK.
TIK.
TIK.

RENN.
SIXTEEN.

IF IT'S WRONG,
IT'S THE MOST
BEAUTIFUL WRONG
I'VE EVER SEEN.

SLOANE.
SIXTEEN.

IT'S NOT
ON ANY
CHART.

THAT'S
THE ONLY
CERTAINTY.

CODA.
UNKNOWN ORIGIN.
LIKELY NOT A
FOX. DEFINITELY
A GOOD GIRL.

UPSIDE-DOWN.
HANGING CITY.

IMPOSSIBLE
BY EVERY
KNOWN LAW.

...AND YET,
THERE.
MARKED.
BY WHATEVER
THIS IS.

WHAT IF
IT'S A TRAP?

WHAT IF
IT'S WHAT
TOOK MY
MOTHER?

THEN WE
GO IN EYES
OPEN.
TOGETHER.

VANGUARD
CADET TEACHING:
FEAR IS DATA.
IGNORANCE IS
THE ENEMY.

WE GATHER.
THEN WE
DECIDE.

TIK.
TIK.
TIK.

CODA
AGREES.

THE LIGHT
SAYS: GO.

THE WIND
SAYS: GO
FASTER.

THE ADVENTURE
SAYS: FINALLY.

SLOANE & RENN

VANGUARD CADETS
YEAR SIXTEEN

LOG ENTRY • 2237.07.14

Clearing weather.
Wind steady at our flank.
No hostiles in the sector.
—Quiet night at the stern.





THE POINT
OF LIGHT.

EVERY CHART
LEADS TO IT.
EVERY STORY
BEGINS THERE.

I JUST HAVE
TO BE THE FIRST
TO ARRIVE.

Bix & CODA

— CHAPTER 1 —
FIRST LIGHT



TICK.
TICK.
TICK.



HEAVY.
LOUD.
UNYIELDING.

BUT IT'S THE
ONLY THING
THAT KNOWS
THE WAY.



TICK.
TICK.
TICK.

I'M SCARED.
OF FAILING.
OF NOT BEING
ENOUGH.

BUT FEAR
DOESN'T GET
A VOTE.



TRINK!



YOU
GOT
THIS.
♡



TODAY,
I'M NOT JUST
FOLLOWING A
LIGHT...

...I'M BECOMING
SOMEONE WORTHY
OF FINDING IT.

DEADZONE - 40 DAYS
NO LIGHT. NO SIGNAL.
JUST GRAY.

UNTIL...

...WE
MADE IT.

THE HANGING CITY

POP. UNKNOWN
ALT. WHO CARES



NEW CHARTING POINT ACQUIRED.
NEXT: DOCKS, DEALS, AND DANGER.



KEEL BREACH -
00:03:17 TO FAILURE

THREE MORE
STITCHES—
HOLD FAST!

BRACE IS
SET. KEEP YOUR
VECTOR TRUE.

RENN - 16
TENSION-GAUNTLET OP.
DON'T LOOK DOWN.

SLOANE - 16
VANGUARD CADET
BRACE & SUPPORT

DIAGRAM'S
OLD BUT—
STARBOARD
RIB RADIUS
MATCHES...

BIX - 14
SYSTEMS & CALCS
PROBABLY
OVERTHINKING THIS.

THWIP!

THREAD
ANGLE GOOD.
TENSION HOLDING
AT 82%...!

SALVAGED SCRAP:
• SHIPYARD PLATE
• RIGGER CABLE
• LUMEN-TWINE SPOOL
• PRAYER (OPTIONAL)

A LITTLE
HIGHER!
THERE!

GOT IT!

TENSION
SPIKING—!

TICK.
TICK.
TICK.

HOLD!
JUST A FEW
MORE—!

PLANK INTEGRITY
CRITICAL!





TETHERBORN

EPISODE 07: HANGING POINT

You don't forget the first time you dock under an upside-down city.

TWANG!

The ropes sing a little different up here.

CHUGGA
CHUGGA
CHUGGA

DOWN HERE!

HEAVE!

SCRRRRREEECH

Every light up there's a story you haven't heard yet.

Welcome to Hanging Point.

Try not to die amazed.

TO BE CONTINUED...